

JEE MAIN REVISION MASTER: ELECTROCHEMISTRY

Subject: Chemistry | Target Scope: JEE Main Previous Years | Empirical Base: 226 Analyzed PYQs

1. High-Yield Concept Priority Matrix

Priority Tier	Concept Name	Frequency	Category
Very High	Nernst Equation & Cell Potential	72 PYQs	Core Formula
Very High	Electrode Potential & Delta G Relation	49 PYQs	Thermodynamics
Very High	Electrolytic Conductance & Cell Constant	42 PYQs	Conductance
Very High	Faraday's Laws of Electrolysis	37 PYQs	Quantitative Electrolysis
Very High	Kohlrausch's Law & Weak Electrolyte Dissociation	21 PYQs	Electrolyte Behavior
Very High	Commercial Batteries, Fuel Cells & Corrosion	17 PYQs	Applied Electrochemistry

2. Master Formula Reference Card

Concept / Topic	Mathematical Formulation & Governing Equations
Nernst Equation & Cell Potential	$E_{\text{cell}} = E^{\circ}_{\text{cell}} - \frac{0.0591}{n} \log_{10} Q, \quad \Delta G^{\circ} = -n F E^{\circ}_{\text{cell}} = -2.303 RT \log_{10} K$
Electrode Potential & Delta G Relation	$\Delta G = -nFE, \quad \Delta G^{\circ}_3 = \Delta G^{\circ}_1 + \Delta G^{\circ}_2 \implies n_3 E^{\circ}_3 = n_1 E^{\circ}_1 + n_2 E^{\circ}_2$
Electrolytic Conductance & Cell Constant	$\kappa = \frac{1}{R} \left(\frac{l}{A} \right) = G \cdot G^*, \quad \Lambda_m = \frac{1000 \cdot \kappa}{M} \quad (\kappa \text{ in } \text{S cm}^{-1})$
Faraday's Laws of Electrolysis	$w = \frac{M \cdot I \cdot t}{n \cdot F}, \quad \text{Moles of metal} = \frac{I \cdot t}{n \cdot F}, \quad F \approx 96500 \text{ C mol}^{-1}$
Kohlrausch's Law & Weak Electrolyte Dissociation	$\Lambda_m^{\circ} = \nu_+ \lambda_+^{\circ} + \nu_- \lambda_-^{\circ}, \quad \alpha = \frac{\Lambda_m}{\Lambda_m^{\circ}}, \quad K_a = \frac{c \alpha^2}{1 - \alpha}$
Commercial Batteries, Fuel Cells & Corrosion	Lead Storage Discharge: $\text{Pb(s)} + \text{PbO}_2\text{(s)} + 2\text{H}_2\text{SO}_4 \rightarrow 2\text{PbSO}_4\text{(s)} + 2\text{H}_2\text{O}$ $\eta = \frac{\Delta G}{\Delta H}$

3. Deep-Dive Concepts & Linked PYQ Evidence

3.1 Nernst Equation & Cell Potential (Very High Yield — 72 PYQs)

Core Principle: Calculation of non-standard cell potential $E_{\text{cell}} = E^{\circ}_{\text{cell}} - (0.0591 / n) \log_{10} Q$ at 298 K, equilibrium constant K_{eq} , and concentration cells where $E^{\circ}_{\text{cell}} = 0$.

■ **Caution / JEE Pitfall:** 1. Forgetting to raise concentrations to their stoichiometric powers in reaction quotient Q . 2. Confusing oxidation vs reduction potential signs: $E^{\circ}_{\text{(red)}} = -E^{\circ}_{\text{(ox)}}$. 3. In concentration cells, anode is always the dilute compartment ($c_1 < c_2$).

■ **Speed Trick:** At 298 K, $E^{\circ} = (0.0591 / n) \log_{10} K$. For spontaneous cell operation, $E_{\text{cell}} > 0$ and $\Delta G < 0$.

Representative Source PYQs:

- **[2026 Morning Shift] Q#1 (MCQ):** "An electrochemical cell is constructed using half cells in the direction of spontaneous change: $\text{Fe}(\text{OH})_2(\text{s}) + 2\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Fe}(\text{s}) + 2\text{OH}^-(\text{aq})$..." **[Ans: N/A]**
- **[2026 Evening Shift] Q#1 (MCQ):** "For a closed circuit Daniell cell, which of the following plots is the accurate one at a given temperature?..." **[Ans: N/A]**
- **[2026 Evening Shift] Q#1 (Numerical):** "Consider the following electrochemical cell : $\text{Pt}|\text{O}_2(\text{g})(1\text{bar})|\text{HCl}(\text{aq})||\text{M}^{2+}(\text{aq}, 1.0\text{M})|\text{M}(\text{s})$ The pH above which, oxygen gas would start to..." **[Ans: 4]**

3.2 Electrode Potential & Delta G Relation (Very High Yield — 49 PYQs)

Core Principle: Relationship between standard reduction potentials and Gibbs free energy: $\Delta G^{\circ} = -nFE^{\circ}$. When combining half-reactions, always add extensive ΔG values, never add intensive E° potentials directly!

■ **Caution / JEE Pitfall:** Directly adding E° potentials of two half-cells to obtain E° of a composite couple (e.g. $\text{Fe}^{3+} \rightarrow \text{Fe}$ from $\text{Fe}^{3+} \rightarrow \text{Fe}^{2+}$ and $\text{Fe}^{2+} \rightarrow \text{Fe}$). You MUST weight by electron transfer count: $n_3 E_3^{\circ} = n_1 E_1^{\circ} + n_2 E_2^{\circ}$!

■ **Speed Trick:** Always write $\Delta G = -nFE$ before combining half-reactions. A more positive standard reduction potential E° denotes a stronger oxidizing agent (more readily reduced).

Representative Source PYQs:

- **[2026 Evening Shift] Q#1 (MCQ):** "Given at 298 K : $E_{\text{(Fe}^{2+}/\text{Fe})}^{\circ} = X\text{Volt}$ $E_{\text{(Fe}^{3+}/\text{Fe})}^{\circ} = Y\text{Volt}$ The $E_{\text{(Fe}^{3+}/\text{Fe}^{2+})}^{\circ}$ is..." **[Ans: B]**
- **[2026 Evening Shift] Q#3 (Numerical):** " MX is a sparingly soluble salt that follows the given solubility equilibrium at 298 K. $\text{MX}(\text{s}) \rightleftharpoons \text{M}^{+}(\text{aq}) + \text{X}^{-}(\text{aq}); K_{\text{sp}} = \dots$ " **[Ans: 200]**
- **[2026 Evening Shift] Q#4 (MCQ):** "Consider the following reduction processes : $\text{Al}^{3+} + 3\text{e}^{-} \rightarrow \text{Al}(\text{s}), E^{\circ} = -1.66\text{V}$ & $\text{Fe}^{3+} + \text{e}^{-} \rightarrow \text{Fe}^{2+}, E^{\circ} = \dots$ " **[Ans: D]**

3.3 Electrolytic Conductance & Cell Constant (Very High Yield — 42 PYQs)

Core Principle: Specific conductivity $\kappa = (1/R) \left(l/A \right) = G \cdot G^*$. Molar conductivity $\Lambda_m = (1000\kappa / M)$ (with κ in $S\,cm^{-1}$) or $\Lambda_m = (\kappa / 1000M)$ (with κ in $S\,m^{-1}$).

■ **Caution / JEE Pitfall:** Unit confusion between cm and m. If κ is in $S\,m^{-1}$, use $\Lambda_m = (\kappa / c)$ (c in $mol\,m^{-3}$). If in $S\,cm^{-1}$, use $\Lambda_m = (1000\kappa / M)$ (M in $mol\,L^{-1}$).

■ **Speed Trick:** Cell constant $G^* = (l/A)$ is an intrinsic geometric property of the conductivity cell and is strictly independent of the electrolyte filled.

Representative Source PYQs:

- **[2026 Evening Shift] Q#1 (Numerical):** "At 298 K, the molar conductivity of $x\%(w/w)$ MX solution (aqueous) is $123.5\,S\,cm^2\,mol^{-1}$. The conductance of same solution is $1.9\,\mu S$." **[Ans: 15]**
- **[2026 Evening Shift] Q#1 (Numerical):** "For strong electrolyte Λ_m increases slowly with dilution and can be represented by the equation $\Lambda_m = \Lambda_m^\circ - k\sqrt{c}$." **[Ans: 4]**
- **[2026 Morning Shift] Q#4 (Numerical):** "The pH and conductance of a weak acid (HX) was found to be 5 and $4 \times 10^{-5}\,S$, respectively. The conductance was measured under st..." **[Ans: 6]**

3.4 Faraday's Laws of Electrolysis (Very High Yield — 37 PYQs)

Core Principle: First and second laws of quantitative electrolysis: Mass deposited $w = Z I t = (M \cdot I \cdot t / n F)$. Total charge passed $Q = I t = n_e F$.

■ **Caution / JEE Pitfall:** 1. Using an incorrect n-factor (electrons transferred per molecule). E.g. for O_2 from H_2O , $n = 4$; for H_2 , $n = 2$. 2. Time t must strictly be substituted in seconds (s).

■ **Speed Trick:** Gas volume at STP: Moles $\times 22.4\,L$. For electroplating, Volume = Area $\times$ Thickness and Mass = Density $\times$ Volume.

Representative Source PYQs:

- **[2026 Morning Shift] Q#4 (Numerical):** "Electricity is passed through an acidic solution of Cu^{2+} till all the Cu^{2+} was exhausted, leading to the deposition of 300 mg of C..." **[Ans: 111]**
- **[2025 Morning Shift] Q#1 (MCQ):** "A solution of aluminium chloride is electrolysed for 30 minutes using a current of 2 A. The amount of the aluminium deposited at the cathod..." **[Ans: N/A]**
- **[2025 Evening Shift] Q#1 (Numerical):** "Electrolysis of 600 mL aqueous solution of NaCl for 5 min changes the pH of the solution to 12. The current in Amperes used for the given e..." **[Ans: 2]**

3.5 Kohlrausch's Law & Weak Electrolyte Dissociation (Very High Yield — 21 PYQs)

Core Principle: Independent migration of ions at infinite dilution: $\Lambda_m^\circ = \nu_+ \lambda_+^\circ + \nu_- \lambda_-^\circ$. Degree of dissociation $\alpha = (\Lambda_m / \Lambda_m^\circ)$, and Ostwald's dilution law $K_a = (c\alpha^2 / 1 - \alpha)$.

■ **Caution / JEE Pitfall:** 1. Forgetting to multiply ionic conductances by stoichiometric coefficients (e.g., for $\text{Al}_2(\text{SO}_4)_3$ implies $2\lambda^\circ(\text{Al}^{3+}) + 3\lambda^\circ(\text{SO}_4^{2-})$). 2. For weak electrolytes, if $\alpha \ll 1$, do not approximate $1 - \alpha \approx 1$.

■ **Speed Trick:** Λ_m° for weak electrolytes like CH_3COOH can be obtained using strong electrolytes: $\Lambda_m^\circ(\text{CH}_3\text{COOH}) = \Lambda_m^\circ(\text{CH}_3\text{COONa}) + \Lambda_m^\circ(\text{HCl}) - \Lambda_m^\circ(\text{NaCl})$.

Representative Source PYQs:

- **[2026 Morning Shift] Q#3 (MCQ):** "Consider the following data. $\begin{matrix} \text{Electrolyte} & \wedge_m^\circ \text{ (S cm}^2 \text{ mol}^{-1}) \\ \text{BaCl}_2 & x_1 \\ \text{H}_2\text{S} & x_2 \end{matrix}$ " **[Ans: A]**
- **[2026 Evening Shift] Q#3 (Numerical):** "Molar conductivity of a weak acid HQ of concentration 0.18 M was found to be 1/30 of the molar conductivity of another weak acid HZ with $c_{\text{HZ}} = 0.18 \text{ M}$..." **[Ans: 2]**
- **[2026 Morning Shift] Q#4 (Numerical):** "The pH and conductance of a weak acid (HX) was found to be 5 and $4 \times 10^{-5} \text{ S cm}^2 \text{ mol}^{-1}$, respectively. The conductance was measured under st..." **[Ans: 6]**

3.6 Commercial Batteries, Fuel Cells & Corrosion (Very High Yield — 17 PYQs)

Core Principle: Primary cells (dry cell, mercury cell), secondary lead-acid batteries (charge/discharge cycles), $\text{H}_2\text{-O}_2$ fuel cells (thermodynamic efficiency $\eta = (\Delta G / \Delta H)$), and electrochemical corrosion prevention.

■ **Caution / JEE Pitfall:** In a lead storage battery, the density of H_2SO_4 decreases during discharge because sulfuric acid is consumed and water is produced.

■ **Speed Trick:** In galvanic cells: Anode is negative, Cathode is positive (An Ox, Red Cat). In electrolytic cells: Anode is positive, Cathode is negative.

Representative Source PYQs:

- **[2025 Evening Shift] Q#2 (MCQ):** "Match List - I with List - II : List - I (Applications) List - II (Batteries/Cell) (A) Transistors (I) Anode - Zn/Hg; Cathode - $\text{HgO} + \text{C}$ (B) ..." **[Ans: N/A]**
- **[2025 Morning Shift] Q#3 (MCQ):** "On charging the lead storage battery, the oxidation state of lead changes from x_1 to y_1 at the anode and from x_2 to y_2 at the cathode..." **[Ans: N/A]**
- **[2025 Evening Shift] Q#3 (MCQ):** "Given below are two statements : Statement (I) : Corrosion is an electrochemical phenomenon in which pure metal acts as an anode and impure ..." **[Ans: N/A]**

4. Benchmark Illustrative PYQs with Master Solutions

Benchmark Problem 1: JEE Main 2026 (Online) 8th April Evening Shift (Q#1)

Given at 298 K : $E^\circ(\text{Fe}^{2+}/\text{Fe}) = X \text{ Volt}$ $E^\circ(\text{Fe}^{3+}/\text{Fe}) = Y \text{ Volt}$ The $E^\circ(\text{Fe}^{3+}/\text{Fe}^{2+})$ in Volt at 298 K is given by :

- (A) $2X - 3Y$
- (B) $3Y - 2X$ **[Correct]**
- (C) $3Y + 2X$
- (D) $Y + X$

Correct Answer: B

Solution Analysis: (i) $\text{Fe}^{2+}(\text{aq}) + 2\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Fe}(\text{s}) \dots \dots \Delta G_1^\circ$ (ii) $\text{Fe}^{3+}(\text{aq}) + 3\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Fe}(\text{s}) \dots \dots \Delta G_2^\circ$ (iii) $\text{Fe}^{3+}(\text{aq}) + \text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Fe}^{2+}(\text{aq}) \dots \dots \Delta G_3^\circ$ iii = ii - i $\times F \times E^\circ(\text{Fe}^{3+}/\text{Fe}^{2+}) = -3 \times F \times y - (-2 \times F \times x)$ $E^\circ(\text{Fe}^{3+}/\text{Fe}^{2+}) = 3y - 2x$ Option (B) is correct

Benchmark Problem 2: JEE Main 2026 (Online) 5th April Evening Shift (Q#1)

At 298 K, the molar conductivity of $x\%(w/w)$ MX solution (aqueous) is $123.5 \text{ S cm}^2 \text{ mol}^{-1}$. The conductance of same solution is $1.9 \times 10^{-3} \text{ S}$. The value of x is $____ \times 10^{-2}$. (Given: cell constant $= 1.3 \text{ cm}^{-1}$; molar mass of MX is 75 g mol^{-1} , density of aqueous solution of MX at 298 K is 1.0 g mL^{-1})

Correct Answer: 15

Solution Analysis: Conductivity (κ) is related to the conductance (G) and the cell constant (G^*) by the following relationship: $\kappa = G \times G^*$. Substituting the given values: $\kappa = (1.9 \times 10^{-3} \text{ S}) \times (1.3 \text{ cm}^{-1})$ $\kappa = 2.47 \times 10^{-3} \text{ S cm}^{-1}$. The molar conductivity (Λ_m) is related to the conductivity (κ) and the molarity (C in mol L^{-1}) by the formula: $\Lambda_m = (\kappa \times 1000 / C)$. Rearranging the formula to solve for molarity (C): $C = \frac{\kappa \times 1000}{\Lambda_m}$. Substituting the values into the equation: $C =$

Benchmark Problem 3: JEE Main 2026 (Online) 22nd January Evening Shift (Q#1)

Consider the following electrochemical cell: $\text{Pt} | \text{O}_2(\text{g}) (1 \text{ bar}) | \text{HCl}(\text{aq}) || \text{M}^{2+}(\text{aq}, 1.0 \text{ M}) | \text{M}(\text{s})$. The pH above which, oxygen gas would start to evolve at anode is $____$ (nearest integer). [Given : $E_{(\text{M}^{2+}/\text{M})}^\circ = 0.994 \text{ V}$, $E_{(\text{O}_2/\text{H}_2\text{O})}^\circ = 1.23 \text{ V}$, standard reduction potential and $(RT/F)(2.303) = 0.059 \text{ V}$ at the given condition]

Correct Answer: 4

Solution Analysis: For the oxygen electrode (reduction reaction): $\text{O}_2(\text{g}) + 4\text{H}^+(\text{aq}) + 4\text{e}^- \rightarrow 2\text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{l})$. Nernst equation: $E_{(\text{O}_2/\text{H}_2\text{O})} = E_{(\text{O}_2/\text{H}_2\text{O})}^\circ - (0.059/4) \log(\frac{1}{p_{(\text{O}_2)}[\text{H}^+]^4})$. Given $p_{(\text{O}_2)} = 1 \text{ bar}$, so $\log p_{(\text{O}_2)} = 0$: $E_{(\text{O}_2/\text{H}_2\text{O})} = 1.23 + 0.059 \log[\text{H}^+]$. Since $\log[\text{H}^+] = -\text{pH}$: $E_{(\text{O}_2/\text{H}_2\text{O})} = 1.23 - 0.059 \text{ pH}$. For the metal electrode: $\text{M}^{2+} + 2\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{M}(\text{s})$. Given $[\text{M}^{2+}] = 1.0 \text{ M}$, hence $E_{(\text{M}^{2+}/\text{M})} = E_{(\text{M}^{2+}/\text{M})}^\circ = 0.994 \text{ V}$. Oxygen will start evolving at the anode when the oxygen electrode becomes the anode, i.e. when its reduction pote

Benchmark Problem 4: JEE Main 2026 (Online) 6th April Morning Shift (Q#3)

Consider the following data. Electrolyte $\wedge_m^\circ (\text{S cm}^2 \text{ mol}^{-1})$: BaCl_2 x_1 , H_2SO_4 x_2 , HCl x_3 , BaSO_4 x_4 . BaSO_4 is sparingly soluble in water. If the conductivity of the saturated BaSO_4 solution is $x \text{ S cm}^{-1}$ then the solubility product of BaSO_4 can be given as (Here $\wedge_m = \wedge_m^\circ$)

- (A) $\frac{10^6 x^2}{(x_1 + x_2 - 2x_3)^2}$ **[Correct]**
- (B) $\frac{x^2}{(x_1 + x_2 - 2x_3)^2}$
- (C) $\frac{x^2}{(x_1 + x_2 - 2x_3)^2} \times 10^6$
- (D) $\frac{x^2}{(x_1 + x_2 + 2x_3)^2}$

Correct Answer: A

Solution Analysis: $\text{BaSO}_4(\text{s}) \rightleftharpoons \text{Ba}^{2+}(\text{aq}) + \text{SO}_4^{2-}(\text{aq})$. If the solubility of BaSO_4 is $s \text{ mol L}^{-1}$, then in solution: $[\text{Ba}^{2+}] = s$, $[\text{SO}_4^{2-}] = s$. Thus, the solubility product is $K_{\text{sp}} = [\text{Ba}^{2+}][\text{SO}_4^{2-}] = s^2$. Relation between molar conductivity and observed conductivity. By definition, $\kappa = \frac{\Lambda_m}{c \times 1000}$ where κ = conductivity in S cm^{-1} , Λ_m = molar conductivity in $\text{S cm}^2 \text{ mol}^{-1}$, c = molar concentration in mol L^{-1} . For the saturated solution of BaSO_4 , $\kappa = x$ and $c = s$. Th

Benchmark Problem 5: JEE Main 2026 (Online) 24th January Morning Shift (Q#4)

Electricity is passed through an acidic solution of Cu^{2+} till all the Cu^{2+} was exhausted, leading to the deposition of 300 mg of Cu metal. However, a current of 600 mA was continued to pass through the same solution for another 28 minutes by keeping the total volume of the solution fixed at 200 mL. The total volume of oxygen evolved at STP during the entire process is _____ mL. (Nearest integer) [Given: $\text{Cu}^{2+}(\text{aq}) + 2\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Cu}(\text{s})$ $E^\circ = +0.34\text{V}$ $\text{O}_2(\text{g}) + 4\text{H}^+ + 4\text{e}^- \rightarrow 2\text{H}_2\text{O}$ $E^\circ = +1.23\text{V}$ Molar mass of Cu = 63.54 g mol⁻¹ Molar mass of O_2 = 32 g mol⁻¹ Faraday Constant = 96500 C mol⁻¹ Molar volume at STP = 22.4 L]

Correct Answer: 111

Solution Analysis: Eq of Cu = Eq of O_2 In electrolysis, the number of equivalents deposited and liberated are equal for the same quantity of electricity. For copper deposition: $\text{Cu}^{2+} + 2\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Cu}$, so n-factor = 2. For oxygen evolution (reverse of given reduction): $2\text{H}_2\text{O} \rightarrow \text{O}_2 + 4\text{H}^+ + 4\text{e}^-$, so n-factor = 4. So, equivalents of Cu deposited = equivalents of O_2 evolved during the first part. $\frac{300 \times 10^{-3} \times 263.54}{n(\text{O}_2)} \times 4 = 2.36 \times 10^{-3} = n(\text{O}_2)$ When current is further passed After all Cu^{2+} is exhausted, the current no